

Section 1: Executive Summary

This proposal introduces a mobile augmented reality (AR) education program designed for Hong Kong's older, non-tech savvy investors. By partnering with HKUST and financial institutions, the program delivers interactive, accessible learning about emerging technologies. This bridges the communication gap, empowering seniors to make informed investment decisions, and enabling financial institutions to expand market reach, build trust, and drive sustainable growth in an aging market.

Section 2: Introduction

Hong Kong's financial sector faces a pressing communication challenge: engaging its rapidly growing population of older, non-tech savvy investors as financial products become increasingly complex and digitalized. Traditional methods fail to meet seniors' needs, leaving them uninformed and hesitant to explore new investment opportunities. This communication gap limits financial inclusion for elderly investors, constraining business growth for institutions. To address this, we propose a mobile augmented reality (AR) education program for seniors, developed with HKUST and financial industry partners. Our objectives are to demystify emerging technologies, empower elderly investors to make informed decisions, and help financial institutions build trust, broaden their customer base, and drive sustainable growth. Outcomes and benefits include enhancing financial literacy, boosting investor confidence, and expanding market reach for industry partners.

This proposal will first analyze the market and communication gaps, before detailing the AR solution, implementation plan and financial plan, ending with a conclusion and call to action.

Section 3: Evaluation of Market & Industry Needs

3.1 Market and Industry Needs

Hong Kong's financial sector is facing a critical inflection point due to a rapidly aging population and the growth of emerging technologies. By 2050, 40% of Hong Kong's population will be over 60, making it the world's oldest city (Liu, 2023). This demographic is typically less familiar with innovations like blockchain and cryptocurrency, resulting in a significant knowledge gap and underrepresentation in new technology investments (IFEC, 2023). Market analysis underscores that identifying and addressing such unmet needs, especially in large, underserved segments of a population, can unlock substantial growth and competitive advantage. As the market for emerging technologies expands, with blockchain alone projected to contribute over USD 1.7 trillion to global GDP by 2030 (CitiGroup, 2021), financial institutions have a unique opportunity to broaden their customer base by empowering older, non-tech savvy investors. Meeting both

their functional and emotional needs, such as trust, security, and confidence in digital tools, will be essential for capturing this market.

3.2 Current Communication Strategies

Traditional communication strategies in Hong Kong's financial sector have not kept pace with the needs of older, less digitally literate investors (Institute of Ageing, The Chinese University of Hong Kong, 2018). Print materials and static webpages, while accessible, lack the interactivity and clarity required to demystify complex technologies. In-person seminars and conferences often rely on technical jargon and are limited by logistical constraints, thus failing to reach a broader, less engaged audience. Even as some institutions adopt creative approaches, content tailored for seniors rarely addresses emerging technologies. For example, IFEC's gamified education programs and HSBC's age-friendly banking resources focus primarily on anti-scam awareness and wealth management, not on new technology investment (HSBC, n.d.; IFEC, 2023). As a result, the communication gap persists, and older investors remain hesitant and uninformed about digital financial opportunities.

3.3 Call for More Innovative Approach

To bridge this gap, there is a pressing need for more innovative, personalized educational strategies. Financial institutions should consider developing immersive, engaging educational tools such as augmented reality (AR) programs, interactive workshops, and personalized digital content that simplify complex concepts and foster trust. By investing in innovative communication, Hong Kong's financial sector can empower older investors, drive broader adoption of emerging technologies, and secure long-term growth. (370 words)

Section 4: Proposing a Solution

4.1 Transformative AR Education Solution (ARES)

We propose an innovative AR education program called ARES tailored for older, non-tech savvy investors in Hong Kong. This program demystifies emerging technologies, such as blockchain, cryptocurrency, and AI by presenting their investment potential in an accessible, engaging way. Delivered via a mobile truck that visits different neighborhoods, the program removes barriers related to transportation and mobility, ensuring direct access for our target users. The primary goal is to empower older investors with the knowledge and confidence to make informed decisions in a rapidly evolving financial landscape.

4.2 Filling the Investment Knowledge Gap

Senior investors often face significant challenges when learning about complex technologies. ARES addresses these gaps through several features:

- **Engagement:** AR technology offers an interactive and immersive experience (Bacca et al., 2014). Concepts can be brought to life through visual simulations, quizzes, and interactive scenarios, making learning intuitive and enjoyable.
- **Accessibility:** The AR interface includes large buttons, intuitive navigation, and customizable settings for font size and contrast, accommodating varying visual needs. The mobile truck format brings the program directly to communities, overcoming geographical barriers.
- **Personalization:** Content adapts to each user's progress, interests, and investment goals, ensuring relevance and resonance.

4.3 Strategic Alignment with Financial Institutions

This AR program aligns with the strategic goals of financial institutions in Hong Kong:

- **Expanding Market Reach:** By targeting older, non-tech savvy investors, institutions can engage a traditionally underserved demographic and expand their customer base (Institute of Ageing, The Chinese University of Hong Kong, 2018).
- **Enhancing Customer Engagement:** Offering innovative, interactive education demonstrates a commitment to empowerment and financial literacy, building trust and loyalty.
- **Promoting Investment in Emerging Technologies:** Educating seniors about new technologies encourages broader investment activity, benefiting both investors and institutions.

4.4 Unmatched Competitive Edge

Our program stands out as Hong Kong's first AR financial literacy initiative for seniors, transforming complex concepts into engaging visuals. Our team will collaborate with the Division of Integrated Systems and Design and the Centre for Aging Science at the Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (HKUST). This partnership ensures technological excellence and age-appropriate, user-friendly content. Content can be regularly updated with input from financial institutions, and the mobile format brings learning directly to seniors, fostering participation and inclusion.

By combining AR technology with a mobile format, our solution addresses the identified gaps which align with financial institutions' business goals, providing a unique competitive advantage.

We believe ARES will transform how seniors learn about and engage with emerging technologies. (414 words)

Section 5: Implementation Plan

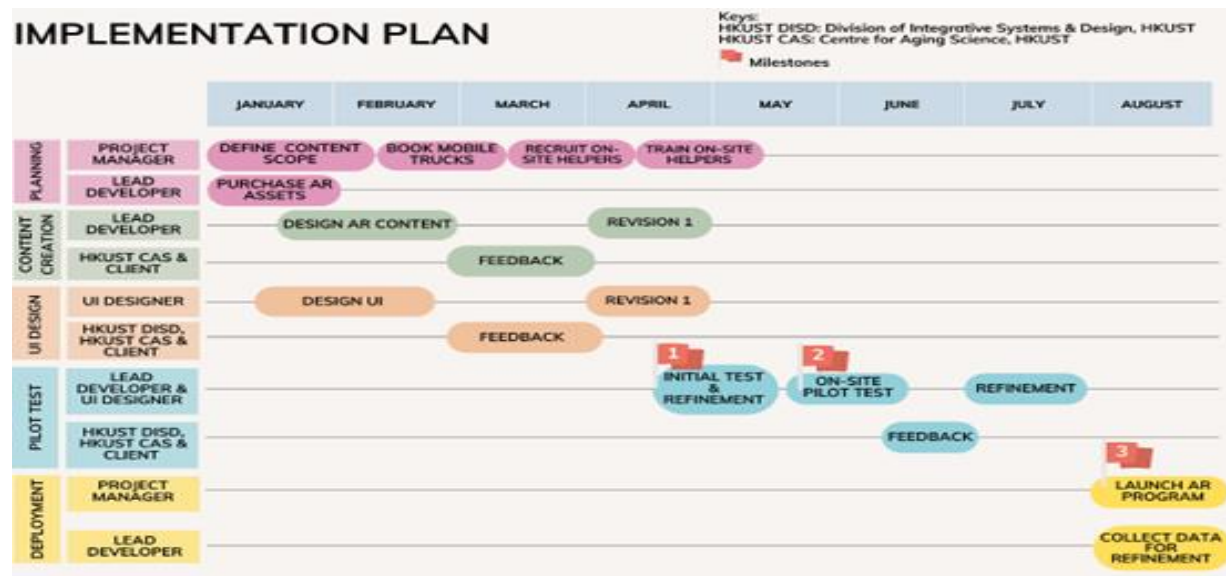


Figure 1: Implementation Plan

5.1 Project Goal

To launch a citywide ARES for client's senior investors by Sep 2025.

5.2 Implementation Timeline

5.2.1 Phase 1: Planning (Jan – Feb)

- Project Manager: define AR content scope with clients & book mobile trucks
- Lead Developer: Purchase AR headsets and other hardware

5.2.2 Phase 2: Content Creation & User Interface (UI) Design (Jan – Apr)

- Lead Developer & UI Designer: Design AR content & UI, revise to incorporate experts' and clients' feedback
- Division of Integrative Systems and Design (DISD): Comment on the UI design based on user experience principles

- Center for Aging Science (CAS): Feedback on the accessibility and usability of the design for elderly users
- Clients: Advise on user preferences, requirements, content relevance, and accuracy
- Project Manager: Recruit and train on-site support staff

5.2.3 Phase 3: Pilot Testing (Apr – July)

- Lead Developer & UI Designer: Conduct initial tests and pilot tests in select locations, refine program
- DISD: Analyze initial test results and advice on UI and AR content refinement
- CAS: Conduct usability testing with elderly users to ensure accessibility
- Project Manager: Organize testing sessions and gather feedback

5.2.4 Phase 4: Full Deployment (August)

- Project Manager: Launch AR program citywide with clients, conduct monthly user survey
- Lead Developer: Analyze survey data for refinement

5.3 Key Milestones

- Mid-May: Completion of content creation & UI design, initial testing
- Mid-June: Successful pilot tests, feedback collected and analyzed, program refinement made
- Late August: AR program operational in all planned locations, user engagement metrics collected (250 words)

Section 6: Financial Plan

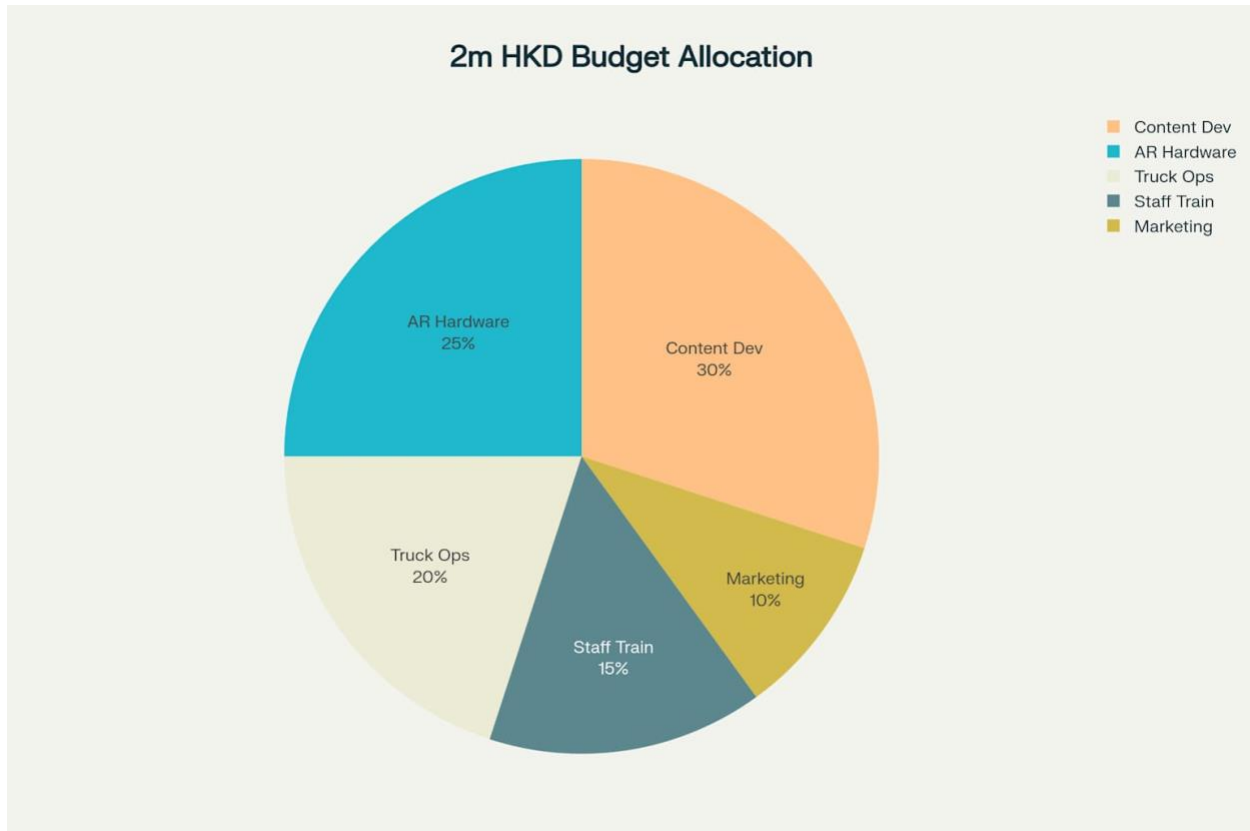


Figure 2: Budget Allocation

ARES financial plan starts with a robust budget of 2 million Hong Kong dollars, strategically allocated to maximize impact and ensure a clear return on investment (ROI) within 18 months. Key budget categories include:

- Content Development (30%):**
 The largest share funds the creation and continual updating of engaging, age-appropriate AR educational content tailored to seniors' needs.
- AR Hardware (25%):**
 A significant portion is allocated to purchasing reliable, user-friendly AR devices to ensure accessibility and smooth operation for senior users.
- Mobile Truck Operations (20%):**
 A dedicated amount covers the costs of operating and maintaining the mobile outreach unit that delivers the program directly to communities.
- Staff Training & Support (15%):**
 This allocation supports the recruitment, training, and retention of on-site staff who guide and assist participants.

- **Marketing & Outreach (10%):**
A targeted budget is reserved for marketing activities to raise awareness and maximize program participation among seniors.

This allocation reflects a balanced approach, prioritizing both technological infrastructure and user engagement. The focused allocation of 300,000 HKD for staff training and 200,000 HKD for marketing efforts, such as social media campaigns, is expected to accelerate program adoption. By month 18, increased participation and financial institution partnerships are projected to generate sufficient value, through expanded customer bases tailored to seniors and service uptake, to achieve full ROI. This offers a compelling case for sustainable growth and competitive advantage in Hong Kong's financial sector. (234 words)

Section 7: Conclusion

ARES empowers Hong Kong's older, non-tech savvy investors by delivering interactive, accessible learning about emerging technologies directly to their communities. Collaborating with HKUST and financial institutions, we ensure content is relevant, engaging, and up to date, helping seniors make informed investment decisions while expanding market reach for financial partners.

Partner with us to:

- bridge the digital knowledge gap
- foster financial inclusion
- unlock new growth opportunities.

By collaborating together, we have the power to transform how Hong Kong's seniors engage with the future of finance.

Word count = 1590 words

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